12.3 Lazy loading

Let's dip our toes into the HTMX waters by doing lazy loading. Sometimes, elements on a web page take a while to calculate or can be slow to load. In some cases, this means the whole page stalls out waiting for a single item. Lazy loading is the idea of showing a page while dynamically inserting the slower content into the page afterwards. To do lazy loading with HTMX, you use the `hx-get` attribute set to the URL of the item to load and the `hx-trigger` attribute set to `"load"`, meaning the GET gets executed once the page has loaded.

To demonstrate this feature, you need two views: one for the main page and one for the dynamically loaded segment. The main page is a view like any other you've written, with its HTML content containing the HTMX tags. The second view gets called by the `hx-get` attribute, and unlike a normal Django page, it only returns a snippet of HTML, called a *partial*.

The Promoters app, added in chapter 10, hasn't gotten enough love—it is only data and no views. Let's add a view that lists your promoters, lazy loading the actual content. The view for the main page is found in the following listing and should be added to RiffMates/promoters/views.py.

Listing 12.1 A promoters listing view

```
# RiffMates/promoters/views.py
from django.shortcuts import render

from promoters.models import Promoter

def promoters(request):
    return render(request, "promoters.html")
```

The corresponding HTML template is in the following listing. This template has a `<div>` tag containing the `hx-get` and `hx-trigger` attributes. When the GET fires, the tag gets replaced by the view's response. The content of the `<div>`, before the GET fires, is a placeholder *loading* message, which is visible until the lazy load is complete.

Listing 12.2 A promoters listing template

```
<!-- RiffMates/templates/promoters.html -->
{% extends "base.html" %}

{% block title %}
  {{block.super}}: Promoter Listing
{% endblock %}

{% block content %}
  <h1>Promoters</h1>

  <div
        hx-get="/promoters/partial_promoters/"
```

hx-get replaces this tag with the contents returned from the URL.